

Leaping across the gap, Vilde you clear the distance into the middle section of the ship. As you land, roll initiative!

All of you watch a large ape with mottled and rotting white fur drop down into the middle of the stern.

Curved tusks protrude out from a snarling mouth as two additional arms extend from its exposed ribcage. As they approach, you see four other smaller ones, some on the large ape, others climbing down on their own make their way quickly down towards you.

"Girallon zombie!" Ayo shouts. "Run!"



Wisdom (Perception) Check

On a DC 15 check with disadvantage, the Party is not surprised by the girallon zombies.

A magenta skull manifests above the head of the largest girallon as Ayo casts *Hunter's Mark*. She nocks her arrow, releasing two with incredible speed. One finds its mark, landing square in the shoulder of the monstrosity. The guide deftly leaps across the branches, landing in the middle of the stern with Vilde.

Seeing that her Party is under attack, Vilde hurls her *Dagger of Returning*. The blade impales inside right in the eye of the rampaging ape, leaving it to roar in pain.

Vanishing in a swirl of mist, Raphael and Salazar appears beside Vilde. Operating in silent synchronicity, the sorcerer channels raw arcana into a crackling

Sorcerous Burst while the wizard mutters the rapid incantation for a *Fire Bolt*. Unintentionally, their magic converges into a singular fiery mote that streaks through the cool jungle air and strikes the undead beast.

Muttering a quick prayer, Hazel casts *Spirit Guardians*. Radiant i'jins explode out from around her, rushing towards and attacking the smaller girallon zombies.

The baby girallons break formation. Throwing aside the glowing rabbits attacking them, two attack the illusory Hazel, sadly to no avail. The other two try to leap across the gap into the middle section of the ship, but only one makes it across.

The large girallon wheels around, barrelling down upon Wukong. The monstrosity sinks its teeth into Wukong as its claws tear devastatingly into the paladin. As blood pours out from the simian, his heart begins to pound in his throat. He can feel his boots get tighter and his spine elongate. With a scream of pain, Wukong barely resists the transformation. He kicks off the large ape, simultaneously enlarging his *Jingubang*. Wukong slams the staff into the ape with tremendous force, crushing his ribcage and sending the fragments into the undead's chest.

Down below, the Party watches the fight break out. Thaisha wildshapes into a falcon, racing up to peck at the towering undead over Wukong. As she does so, she draws the attention of the undead baby girallons attacking Hazel, prompting one to leap in the air and seize the druid. The baby girallon slams her into the ground, breaking her out of her wildshape.

Wang Lei commands his zombie monkey, sending it up to help. Red lasers fire from the paladin's eyes, striking the back of the large undead's head. The force of the blast shatters its skull, but the zombie stands strong, still animated by some necromantic magic. Following his knight's lead, Mason fires with his *Heavy Crossbow*. Its bolt deals the killing blow, bringing down the massive girallon.

As the biggest threat is dealt with, and with Raphael engaging the undead, Vilde and Salazar quickly assess their surroundings.

Surveying the middle section, you realize that this is the "engine" room, if it can even be called that. The first thing that seizes your attention are three skeletons, who are lying spread out across the room.

Intelligence (Investigation) Check

On a DC 10 check, the Party sees dried ration wrappings around the room; they intuit that the three people sealed themselves in this room and, when rations ran out, ultimately starved to death.

Salazar and Vilde, you see the shadows of the skeletons lengthen as three dark, vengeful wraiths crawl into existence.

"You've abandoned us, Ayo," the wraith whispers. "You should not have come back here."

A look of realization passes over Ayo's eyes as the wraiths come into existence. Formerly Ayo's crewmates - Falx, Sylvio and Bravewing - their tragic deaths have left them seeking vengeance.

Ayo mutters their name in fear as the three wraiths swarm the guide, life draining from her. In an instant, she is killed. Her formerly corporeal body becomes vaguely translucent as her light is sucked into the open maw of the dark wraiths, leaving behind only darkness.

"Wait, stop!" Vilde protests. "Why did you guys kill her? She was your friend!"

"She left us to die," the wraith's raspy voice was barely audible.

Wisdom (Insight) Check

On a DC 15 check, Vilde sees the wraiths' attentions are now drawn to Salazar.

"They're coming for you next!" Vilde warns Salazar.

Still in pitched combat with the undead baby ape, Raphael's *Crimson Rapier* flash forward. The blade stabs into the monkey. The monkey's crushing jaws gnash together hungrily and almost finds purchase on Raphael, but the sorcerer's bloodwell vial glow with purple light at the last second as a forcefield erupts between them, knocking the undead back.

Wanting to get away from the wraiths, Salazar casts *Misty Step*, appearing in the stern once more. He jumps off the ship, slamming into the ground. He scurries over to Mason and Wang Lei, saying that "there's some nasty shit up there."

Back at the stern, the baby girallon zombie leaps on Thaisha, its powerful claws digging into the druid's abdomen and slashing it open. The other attacks Wukong, who pushes the undead back while retaining control. Renewed with vigor, Wukong casts *Lay on Hands* to heal himself as he sweeps the quarterstaff on the floor, toppling the baby girallon and knocking it prone.

Thaisha casts *Barkskin*, summoning a layer of thick wood around her. She tries a similar move to trip the girallon zombie, but the undead ape merely does a somersault to avoid getting knocked prone.





Wang Lei's zombie monkey sink its teeth around the neck of its brother, crushing its windpipe in a violent bite. Its arms tear into its brother's arms, ripping it limb from limb. And yet, the baby girallon displays tremendous fortitude, still roaring and snarling. From below, Wang Lei fires *Eldritch Blasts* at the undead girallon grappling with Raphael.

Eager to extinguish another light, the four wraiths surge forwards towards Thaisha. Life begins to drain from the druid as the wraiths begin to suck out her soul. She crumples and falls unconscious, surrounded by enemies. Before they can finish the job, one of Hazel's radiant rabbits flies directly into the centre of a wraith, exploding inside it and smiting the undead badly.

Having climbed up another tree, Hazel's duplicate moves deeper into the stern of the ship, defending Thaisha and holding the wraiths back with its radiant glow.

Raising aloft his *Staff of Storms*, Salazar's eyes glow white as dark, storm clouds begin to gather around the Wreck. Muttering a word of power, the wizards *Calls Lightning*. A smell of rushing ozone fills the deck of the ship as a crack of lightning strikes the stern, blasting the wraiths and finally killing the baby girallon tank.

On the middle of the ship, Vilde helps Raphael with his form as the sorcerer gets used to his new weapon. She draws her *Frost Brand Scimitar* and slashes the undead ape, shouting encouragement and tips to the sorcerer. Raphael learns quickly, following the rogue as he finally drives his rapier straight into the undead's throat. The

girallon zombie falls over the edge to the ground below, dead. As they celebrate, the pair did not notice that the girallon zombie that had failed to make the jump earlier had made its way back up. The girallon charges at Raphael, its fists pummeling into his back. The sorcerer flies off the edge.

Quicker than gravity, Vilde's gauntlet fires a line of web and catches the sorcerer, pulling him back up. The girallon zombie rampages forward again, attempting to push the invaders out of his home. Raphael stands firm, holding back the baby girallon with his arm. Vilde spin-kicks the undead monkey off the middle section of the ship.

Wukong unleashes a *Guiding Bolt*. The radiant blast completely incinerates a wraith, dissipating the vengeful spirit of Falx and sending it back to where it came from. The simian plucks out a strand of his hair and blows it. The hair shifts into a clone of himself, which he sends to leap onto the middle of the ship.

Around Thaisha, green necromantic energy explodes outwards. The energy washes over the wraiths and the undead girallon, before pulling back like a receding wave and healing the druid. She snaps awake as Wang Lei's *Wither and Bloom* spell ends. Wang Lei's zombie monkey leaps up at his master's command, crushing his brother's neck in a vicious bite.

Seeing one of its kind vaporized, the wraiths flit back into their bodies. They float above their withered skeletons, waiting quietly. With no other creatures trying to kill them, Vilde surmises that they must have

starved to death here. She tosses three *Goodberries* on the floor, before using her web to swing across to the stern.

Still concentrating on *Call Lightning*, Salazar summons another bolt from the skies. It strikes two of the wraiths, and completely vaporises the spirit of Ayo. With all of its undead family destroyed, the last girallon zombie scampers off into the jungle, having lost its home.

Astride Khan, Wang Lei moves to see the wraiths hiding in the dark. He fires another two *Eldritch Blasts* from his eyes, blasting one of the wraiths and drawing its attention. Both of the wraiths whip their head around and dive straight past Wukong's clone and Vilde towards Wang Lei. Both of them land an attack of opportunity on the vengeful spirits.

The wraiths reach Wang Lei just in time for Hazel to leap in front of the paladin, allowing the last *Spirit Guardians* to smite and disintegrate the spirits of Sylvio and Bravewing.

With the combat over, Vilde uses her web to pull the rest of the Party up. As they gather around Thaisha to check on the half-orc, she asks about Ayo.

"We should bury her," Thaisha says. "We may have had our tensions, but she was an invaluable part of our team. We should show her the proper respect."

"It's okay," Salazar lies. "I've buried her already."

"Oh really?" Thaisha asked, confused. "When would you have the time during the fight to do that?"

"Well, that was a lie," Vilde says, her eyes narrow accusingly at the wizard. "I saw what happened to her. The wraiths, they drained the life out of her. She's gone. There was no body. Also," The rogue turns to Hazel. "The Hag's Bane's missing. I don't see it here."

As the Party continues to discuss their next steps, they suddenly realize that Raphael is missing. Unbeknownst to the rest, the sorcerer has *Misty Step* to the end section of the ship.

Color Out Of Space

Entering the end of the ship, you see that this room is occupied. Standing in the middle of the room is a thin, unnaturally tall humanoid with pale white skin and a featureless face. He is wearing nothing, and carrying what looks like a huge paintbrush. He has his back against all of you, and is not moving at all.

His attention seems to be focused on something in the desk: a small, wooden locked box. Raphael, you recognize the crest on this box - it is your house's crest.

Pulling out his signet ring, Raphael presents it to the entity. Waving it around, the creature ignores the sorcerer. Remembering the phrases carved around the ship, Raphael realizes that the aberration in front of him must be his father.

Webbing across, Vilde helps everyone make their way into the end section of the ship. As the Party arrives, they watch as Raphael steps out of reach of the aberration, his hand closing around the box.

As you go for the box, the creature inhales a suffocating vortex, stripping the vibrant hues from your flesh, armor, and soul. The world bleeds out into a dull grey as the stolen brilliance implodes into a blinding, sickly yellow light above. Reality tears open beneath your feet as all of you plunge through the fracture, landing violently upon cold stone slab ruins within a murky, submerged shrine echoing with crimson power. Surrounding you, pulsing blood-red orbs and sinister tentacles writhe against the abyssal darkness.

Raphael, this sight is not unfamiliar to you. You've seen this place before, in your dreams. All of you gain Resistance to Psychic damage just as a look of realization passes over the sorcerer. You are all trapped in Raphael's mind.

The Dangerous Mind of Raphael Antarra

Trapped in Raphael's mind, the Party suffers the following effects:

- *Resistance to Psychic Damage.* Raphael empowers the Party with the same mental fortitude he has.
- *Lair Actions.* On initiative count 20, Raphael rolls a d20 dice. He can record the dice result and replace any d20 test using his Reaction.
- *Environmental Damage.* Any area-of-effect damage cast by the Party dealt from a spell deals quarter damage to Raphael.
- *Erased of Name.* If Raphael dies, all those who are trapped in his mind dies.
- *Chains of Fate.* Any damage that Raphael takes, the Party takes half.

In addition, as they combat the *Color Out Of Space*, colors are stripped magically from the Party. On a failed DC 20 Constitution saving throw, a creature has their color stolen. A creature that has a color stolen suffers the corresponding effects:

- *Red.* The creature cannot regain hit points.
- *Blue.* The creature cannot cast spells of 1st level or higher.
- *Yellow.* The creature cannot take Reactions.

The horrific drain leaves its mark. As the blinding yellow glare fades, the physical toll of the vortex becomes terrifyingly clear. Most of the Party has been hollowed out: Mason and Raphael look down at their

hands to find the rich, deep blues of their attire, armor and person completely eradicated. Across from them, Wang Lei and Thaisha suffer the opposite tragedy: the warm yellow tints of their golden filigree and holy symbols have been violently ripped away.

Wukong stands alone, bathed in absolute, sickening monochrome red. The creature's siphon had devoured every trace of yellow and blue from his form, leaving his fur, armor, and skin looking as though they were painted in fresh, wet crimson. Beside him, Hazel has had her red and yellow hues stripped clean to the soul, rendering the cleric unnervingly blue.

Vilde and Salazar stand untarnished. By sheer force of will, their flesh, armor, and gear retain their full, brilliant spectrum, casting them as surreal beacons of normalcy amidst the nightmare.

